

AVA JOHNSON

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EDUCATION

University of California Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA
BS in Computer Science: Computer Game Design

Expected Graduation March 2027

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

Game Developers Association (GDA) at UCSC, *Outreach Officer*, Santa Cruz, CA June 2026 – Present

- Lead outreach initiatives connecting students with game industry professionals, studios, and opportunities
- Coordinate club events, workshops, and external partnerships to grow membership and campus visibility
- Serve as primary point of contact between GDA and outside organizations

Film Production Coalition (FPC) at UCSC, *Camera Operator, Boom Operator & Editor*, Santa Cruz, CA Winter 2025 – Present

- Worked on-set across multiple short film productions in camera, sound, and editorial roles
- Collaborated with cast and crew in fast-paced environments, adapting to evolving creative direction
- Edited short film footage in post-production, shaping pacing, tone, and narrative flow

WORK EXPERIENCE

UCSC Admissions, *Video Production Assistant & Editor*, Santa Cruz, CA June 2025 – Present

- Pitched, filmed, and edited short-form videos in Adobe Premiere Pro and After Effects for the UCSC Admissions Instagram
- Produced multiple high-performing videos including one exceeding 600,000 views and several with 100,000+ views each, on a previously small-reach account
- Grew account following by hundreds through consistent, audience-targeted content
- Developed creative content strategies to drive prospective student engagement and showcase campus life
- Networked with clubs and professors to coordinate shoots across departments; analyzed audience response to continuously refine messaging

AAUW California / Tech Trek AAUW, *Web Designer & Videographer*, Davis, CA & Remote July 2023, 2024, 2025

- Designed, built, and managed the event website for AAUW California each summer, maintaining content and functionality throughout the event cycle
- Served as sole videographer and photographer for Tech Trek, a week-long STEM camp at UC Davis, covering all programming across multiple concurrent sessions
- Coordinated all production shoots, managed footage libraries, and edited the final recap video; collaborated with AAUW leadership to align deliverables with organizational goals

Nevada County Media, *Video Intern*, Grass Valley, CA December 2021 – June 2023

- Produced community-focused video content raising awareness of local issues, from concept through final edit
- Developed expertise in video hook techniques and audience retention strategies to maximize engagement
- Operated multicam setups for live-streamed events, managing real-time switching and recording
- Built communication and networking skills collaborating with community members and stakeholders

SKILLS

Video & Design: Adobe Premiere Pro, Adobe After Effects, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Lightroom, Adobe Express

Programming: Python, C, C#, JavaScript, HTML, CSS

Production: Camera operation, boom operation, multicam live production, short-form content strategy

Other: Web design & management, community outreach, cross-functional collaboration, Windows 10/11, macOS